October 2026 — Month digest

Use this page for quick revision. Detail lives in the topic sheets. Full boards → Master tables.

Must-score table

#	Fact	Easy fact	Open
1	5 New Classical Languages	Union Cabinet approved **5 new Classical Languages**: **Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, and Bengali**; total in India jumps from 6 to **11**	Schemes / Policies · Culture
2	51st Chief Justice of India	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna** appointed as the **51st Chief Justice of India (CJI)** (formal notification 24 Oct; oath 11 Nov), succeeding CJI D.Y. Chandrachud	Appointments
3	Nobel Prize in Medicine	**Victor Ambros** & **Gary Ruvkun** (USA) for the discovery of **microRNA** and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation	Awards · Health
4	Nobel Prize in Physics	**John J. Hopfield** & **Geoffrey E. Hinton** for foundational discoveries enabling **machine learning with artificial neural networks**	Awards
5	Nobel Prize in Chemistry	**David Baker** (computational protein design) + **Demis Hassabis** & **John M. Jumper** (protein structure prediction via AlphaFold)	Awards
6	Nobel Prize in Literature & Peace	Literature: **Han Kang** (South Korea — 1st South Korean); Peace: **Nihon Hidankyo** (Japan atomic bomb survivors grassroots organisation)	Awards
7	Nobel in Economics	**Daron Acemoglu, Simon Johnson, & James A. Robinson** for studies on how **institutions are formed and affect prosperity**	Awards
8	Rabi MSP 2025–26 / 2026–27	Wheat MSP hiked by **₹150** to **₹2,425/quintal**; Rapeseed & Mustard hiked by **₹300** to **₹5,950/quintal** (highest absolute hike); Barley ₹1,980; Gram ₹5,650; Lentil ₹6,700	Economy
9	PM Modi in Varanasi (20 Oct)	Inaugurated projects worth **₹6,700+ crore** including **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital**, **Sigra Sports Complex (Phases 2 & 3)**, and **Varanasi Airport expansion** foundation (₹2,870 cr)	UP Special
10	8th Ayodhya Deepotsav	Guinness World Record lighting **26,17,215 earthen diyas** across **56 ghats** along the Saryu River (Ram Ki Paidi); simultaneous Maha Aarti by **2,128 priests**	UP Special
11	India's 2nd VLF Station	Defence Minister Rajnath Singh laid the foundation stone for India's 2nd naval **Very Low Frequency (VLF) Station** at **Damagundam Forest, Vikarabad (Telangana)** (1st is INS Kattabomman, Tirunelveli, TN)	Science / Defence
12	16th BRICS Summit & Border Pact	16th BRICS Summit in **Kazan, Russia** (22–24 Oct); India & China reached an LAC patrolling disengagement pact in Eastern Ladakh (**Demchok & Depsang**); structured Modi–Xi bilateral meeting held	International

Confused pairs

Wrong idea	Correct fact
Total Classical Languages in India = 6 or 8	Total is now **11** (Tamil, Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Odia + Marathi, Pali, Prakrit, Assamese, Bengali)
Hindi is a Classical Language	**No** — Hindi is the official language of the Union (Art. 343) and an Eighth Schedule language, but **not** a notified Classical Language
51st CJI = Justice B.R. Gavai	**Justice Sanjiv Khanna** is the 51st CJI; Justice B.R. Gavai is slated to succeed him later in 2025
Nobel Physics was for quantum mechanics	It was awarded for **artificial neural networks & machine learning** (Hopfield & Hinton)
Wheat MSP = ₹2,275 per quintal	That was the older rate; revised MSP is **₹2,425 per quintal** (+₹150 hike)
Damagundam VLF station is India's first	It is India's **second** VLF naval communication facility; 1st is **INS Kattabomman** (Tirunelveli, Tamil Nadu, 1990)
ICC Women's T20 World Cup won by Australia/India	Won by **New Zealand** (defeating South Africa by 32 runs in Dubai; maiden title)
23rd SCO Heads of Government Summit was in Beijing	Held in **Islamabad, Pakistan** (attended by EAM S. Jaishankar — 1st Indian EAM visit to Pakistan in 9 years)

Days / themes

Date	Day	Theme / slogan
2 Oct	International Day of Non-Violence	Gandhi Jayanti observance
5 Oct	World Teachers' Day	Standing with teachers: valuing teacher voices for education
7 Oct	World Cotton Day	Cotton for Good
8 Oct	Indian Air Force Day	92nd Anniversary air show held at Marina Beach, Chennai
9 Oct	World Post Day	150 years of enabling communication and empowering peoples
10 Oct	World Mental Health Day	It is time to prioritize mental health in the workplace
11 Oct	International Day of the Girl Child	Girls' vision for the future
12 Oct	World Migratory Bird Day	Protect Insects, Protect Birds
13 Oct	International Day for Disaster Risk Reduction	Empowering the next generation for a resilient future
15 Oct	World Students' Day	Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam birth anniversary
16 Oct	World Food Day	Right to foods for a better life and a better future / Innovate today. Nourish tomorrow
20 Oct	World Statistics Day	Collaborative data for resilient governance
24 Oct	United Nations Day & World Polio Day	A Campaign to Reach Every Child

Also useful

- **Global Hunger Index (GHI) 2024/2026:** India ranked **105th out of 127 countries** (Score: **27.3**, Category: **Serious**; Child Wasting: **18.7%**; published by Welthungerhilfe and Concern Worldwide).
- **Global Innovation Index (GII) 2024/2026:** India rose to **39th rank** out of 133 economies (published by WIPO; Switzerland ranked #1 for 14th year; India #1 in Central/Southern Asia and lower-middle-income group).
- **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award:** Conferred upon veteran actor **Mithun Chakraborty** at the 70th National Film Awards ceremony (Best Actor: Rishab Shetty for *Kantara*; Best Actress: Nithya Menen & Manasi Parekh; Best Feature Film: *Aattam*).
- **Space Milestones:** SpaceX Starship Flight 5 made history on **13 Oct** by catching the Super Heavy booster mid-air with launch tower mechanical arms ("chopsticks"). NASA launched **Europa Clipper** on **14 Oct** atop SpaceX Falcon Heavy to explore Jupiter's icy moon.
- **Assembly Elections: Nayab Singh Saini** sworn in as Haryana CM (BJP 48 seats) on **17 Oct**; **Omar Abdullah** sworn in as the **first Chief Minister of the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir** on **16 Oct**.
- **Exercise Malabar 2026:** Quad maritime exercise (India, US, Japan, Australia) conducted off Visakhapatnam and the Bay of Bengal from **8–18 Oct**.
- **RBI Monetary Policy (Oct):** Repo rate unchanged at **6.50%**; stance shifted to **"Neutral"**.

UP tip

- **Varanasi Package (20 Oct):** PM Modi inaugurated the **RJ Sankara Eye Hospital** at Harhua, the modernised **Dr. Sampoornanand Sports Complex at Sigra** (Phases 2 & 3), and laid the foundation stone for the **₹2,870 crore runway and terminal expansion of Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport**.
- **Ayodhya Deepotsav:** Reached **26,17,215 earthen diyas** across 56 ghats along the Saryu River (Guinness Record), paired with a synchronized Maha Aarti by **2,128 priests**.
- **UP International Trade Show (UPITS):** 2nd edition held at India Expo Centre & Mart, **Greater Noida** with **Vietnam** as the Partner Country.

UK tip

- **Char Dham Winter Portals Closure:** Gangotri, Yamunotri, Kedarnath, and Badrinath portals announced winter closure dates starting from Govardhan Puja / Bhai Dooj toward Ukhimath, Joshimath, Kharsali, and Mukhba winter seats. Keep the winter seats matched to shrines!
- **Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Rules:** State rules drafting committee headed by Shatrughan Singh completed final operational portal workflows for compulsory marriage and live-in relationship registration under the Uttarakhand UCC Act.

Next

Master tables for full boards. Seed **November 2026** after the 51st CJI formal oath (11 Nov) and COP29 Climate Summit tally.